

COGNITION & DECISION MAKING

FINAL EXAM INSTRUCTIONS SUMMER 2025

In week 5, there will be a reduced course load to help you prepare for the final exam in week 6.

The final exam has a quiz component and a short-essay component.

1. The Essay (mini-review)

- **Time:** Submit the mini-review online by **noon** on **Wednesday, July 2nd**. Note that extensions cannot be granted due to grading deadlines.
- **Format:** **Two to three pages, single spaced**, is recommended. However, I do not enforce penalties for word counts. The length recommendation is a guideline based on good mini-reviews I graded in the past. I prefer the following format: the font should be Arial, 12pt; the paragraphs should be justified; the line spacing should be *single*. Save as a *PDF* document and upload to Canvas ("Submit mini-review"). Write your name at the top of the page.
- **Content:** The review should expand on writing assignment D in the following ways: (i) State a research question and explain why it is of theoretical and/or practical importance and hence worthy of study. (ii) Summarize the content of at least three of the articles cited in writing assignment D and explain how they are relevant to the research question – e.g. do they have problems or limitations that you will overcome? Do they draw conclusions that suggest an answer to your research question? (iii) State an answer to the research question.
- **Specifics:**
 - Please **do not use ChatGPT** – aside from ethical concerns, it often doesn't explain the *content* of the articles but rather produces something akin to an abstract (what the article is *about*).
 - Do not upload an **unreadable document**. You must check that the submission can be read in Canvas. If you are struggling with the assignment, I am happy to help you.
 - If you are stuck, look at some multi-study journal articles. In the introduction, how did they summarize the existing literature and justify their research question? How did the multiple studies build on each other?

2. The Quiz

Format:

- Online via Canvas.
- **Open-book** (no lockdown browser).

- **40 multiple-choice** questions worth 2 points each.
- **2 short-answer** questions worth 10 points each (answers should be less than 200 words).

Duration:

- You will have **80 minutes**.
- You may take the midterm any time from **Friday, June 27th to Monday, June 30th**.
- You cannot close out of the quiz and open it up again.

Content:

- The exam will cover material from Weeks 1 to 5.
- Questions are restricted to material covered in the lectures; content from the textbook that was not covered in the lectures will not be included.

Specifics:

- No need to know author names except for being able to cite the following names in relation to their research traditions: Daniel Kahneman, Amos Tversky, Baruch Fischhoff, and Gerd Gigerenzer.
- Dates of papers and statistics from experiments are not required, but you should be familiar with the basic experimental setups and their outcomes. For example, you should know that when people were asked to judge the quality of four identical pairs of stockings, the right-most pair was overchosen; you do not need to know that 40% of participants chose the right-most pair.
- While probability theory is included, calculations will not be necessary. For example, you will need to know Bayes Theorem and how to translate statements like “there is a 10% chance that a person with the disease tests negative” into conditional probabilities, but will not be asked to use Bayes Theorem to work out the probability that the person has the disease given that they test positive.

Technical Issues:

- If you encounter any technical issues during the exam, please contact me immediately via a Canvas message or a text message (614-369-6560). Rutgers IT will have a record of when you began the exam.

Submission Instructions:

- Once you have completed the exam, double-check that you have submitted it properly through Canvas.

Honor Code:

- Remember to adhere to the academic integrity policy. While the exam is open-book, collaboration with others is not permitted. Ensure that all work submitted is your own.